

could go back, I would beg, borrow, whatever to get the down payment and I'd buy that first fourplex and then I would live in it and learn all the ropes of being a landlord by living in one of the four units (and renting out the other three units) and dealing with my tenants . . . As I got that thing cash flowing, as soon as I got it working based on four units of rental, I go out and get another one. By the time you get three of those, you're done. *You're done*. It's the simplest, easiest way to achieve financial independence for somebody in their twenties."

Chad "Coach" Carson provides a perfect example of this advice applied. He achieved FI before the age of forty. His first investment was buying a fourplex and living in one of the units. He said, "By getting the rent from those other units, you can use that to pay your housing . . . That is the concept of house hacking. You're finding some way to generate income from your residence instead of just living there and having all the money go out the door." Carson added, "I challenge [you] to take away your housing payment, put that in a future value calculator, and figure out what that means for you ten to twenty years down the road. If you weren't that motivated before, I think that will start getting you more interested in the concept."